

Jingwen Wu

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Summary

I am a **mixed-methods** researcher with strong **quantitative** expertise, studying how digital technologies reshape access to information, social inclusion, and civic engagement. My work integrates **large-scale** cross-national **surveys**, **experiments**, and in-depth **interviews** to link patterns of digital behavior with lived experience. I have 8 publications, a book element under contract with *Cambridge University Press*. My research has received 28 awards and fellowships, including funding from the *National Science Foundation* and the *National Institute on Drug Abuse*. I investigate how people make decisions in digital environments and communicate findings through clear, data-driven visual narratives.

Education

University of Texas at Austin

Ph.D. in Government/Political Science (GPA: 4.0)

*Expected
May/2027*

◦ *Dissertation: Politics in the Digital Age*

– studies how digital technologies reshape participation, accountability, and social inclusion.

University of Kentucky

M.A. in Political Science (GPA: 3.9) — Crum Best Graduate Student Award

2024

Survey & Data Skills

- **Survey & Experimental Design:** sampling, weighting, survey development, field experiments, A/B tests, conjoint and vignette designs; proficient in Qualtrics and SurveyMonkey.
- **Quantitative methods:** causal inference (difference-in-differences, instrumental variables, regression discontinuity, matching, mediation, population placebo, two-way fixed effects), regression, multilevel and survival models, longitudinal and panel analysis, time-series forecasting, t-test, chi-square, ANOVA.
- **Programming & Data:** R, Stata, Python, SPSS, SQL; reproducible data cleaning, merging, and harmonization across large-scale surveys.
- **Visualization & Reporting:** Tableau, Power BI, R Markdown, L^AT_EX; skilled in presenting statistical results clearly; presented findings at 16+ international conferences.

Experience

Ph.D. Student Researcher / Instructor

2020–Present

University of Texas at Austin & University of Kentucky

- Built and harmonized large-scale cross-national survey datasets (200K+ obs.) from Afro/Asia Barometer, GSMA, Pew, World Values Survey, World Bank, and ITU; automated cleaning, merging, and weighting workflows in **R**, **Stata**, and **SQL** to ensure **reproducible analysis**.
- Designed and implemented **surveys** and **vignette experiments** (quota sampling) to test behavioral and informational hypotheses using **causal inference** methods—DiD, IV, Mediation, Placebo, TWFE, and multilevel models.
- Delivered interpretable, visual results through dashboards and Beamer reports; findings informed GSMA and UN Women inclusion metrics and were presented at 16+ international conferences.

Program Evaluation Researcher

2019

Morehead State University

- Wrote and implemented a **full program evaluation** using **pre/post surveys** to measure learning outcomes; synthesized results into a **data-driven report** adopted by university leadership for program improvement.

Product Analytics Intern

Sep 2017 – Feb 2018

TCL Hawk Internet, Beijing

- Analyzed 4.8M smart-TV interaction logs using **SQL** and **regression modeling** to conduct **A/B tests** of interface design; identified changes that raised click-through by **11%** and reduced navigation time by **15%**.
- Collaborated with **UX and product teams** to implement iterative experiments that **increased daily active users by 9%** during the testing phase.

Selected Projects & Applications

- [1] **Gender Digital Divide & Participation** (Cross-National, Mixed Methods) *Current*
- **Research Question:** How does the **digital divide exacerbate gender gaps** in civic participation and trust in developing countries?
 - **Approach:**
 - Harmonized a 137-country dataset combining **individual-level** and **national** indicators.
 - **Modeled** how differences in mobile connectivity predict gendered patterns of participation.
 - Applied **causal inference techniques** (Two-way fixed effects, Population placebo) to isolate digital access effects.
 - Integrated **mediation analysis**, **focus groups**, and **interviews** to identify information pathways.
 - **Impact:** Demonstrated that unequal connectivity amplifies civic participation gaps by 10–15% between men and women, showing that digital exclusion, not culture, drives inequality. This research produced a replicable framework for evaluating digital equity in large-scale survey systems.
- [2] **Decision Behavior & Accountability Cues** (Survey Experiment) *Published*
- **Research Question:** Do different **voting rule structures** change how people assign blame for corruption?
 - **Approach:**
 - Conducted and Designed a preregistered online **survey** experiment (N=1,000).
 - Randomized voting rules, candidate gender, and partisanship to identify attribution mechanisms.
 - Applied **t-tests**, **chi-square analysis**, and **regression modeling** to evaluate how institutional cues shape fairness and responsibility perceptions.
 - **Impact:** Produced causal evidence from randomized assignment that direct voting heightens individual accountability while party-list systems diffuse responsibility. The experimental framework parallels A/B testing of design cues that shape user trust and attribution.
- [3] **Source Credibility & Algorithmic Recommendation** (2×2 Vignette Experiment) *Current*
- **Research Question:** How do **information source** (social media vs. official) and **algorithmic display** (recommended vs. chronological) influence users' **trust**, **perceived bias**, and **engagement intentions**?
 - **Approach:**
 - Conducted a **2×2 factorial vignette experiment** to test how algorithmic presentation affects perception.
 - Randomized both source type and feed order in **Qualtrics** to isolate causal effects on user trust.
 - Evaluated reliability using **Cronbach's α** and **factor analysis**.
 - Estimated **heterogeneous treatment effects** in R to identify differences in perceived credibility and engagement.
 - **Impact:** Built an experimental framework to evaluate how source labeling and recommendation transparency shape user trust and engagement patterns, providing a scalable design for A/B testing fairness and exposure balance in algorithmic feeds.

Selected Publications & Research Outputs

- **Book Project**
 - Tiffany D. Barnes, Emily Rains, Jakana Thomas, & **Jingwen Wu**. *Mind the Gap: Gender Gaps in Civic Engagement and the Gender Digital Divide*. Under contract with *Cambridge University Press*.
- **Peer-Reviewed Research & Applied Projects**
 - **Jingwen Wu**, Tiffany D. Barnes, Nathan Batto, & Emily Beaulieu (2024). "Mixed-Member Systems, Corruption, and Accountability." In *Gender and Corruption in Democracies*. Edward Elgar.
 - Tiffany D. Barnes, Emily Rains, Jakana Thomas, & **Jingwen Wu** (2026). "The Gender Digital Divide and Protest Participation." *Journal of Peace Research*.
 - **Jingwen Wu**. "Empowering the Ruler or the Ruled: How 3G Shapes Government Human Rights Practices." *Crum Outstanding Graduate Student Paper Award* (2023); presented at ISA, PolMeth, and APSA.

Certifications

Empirical Implications of Theoretical Models Summer Institute, Princeton University (NSF, 2023) — **Longitudinal Data Analysis Workshop**, Purdue University (NIDA, 2025) — **Data Science Boot Camp**, Erdős Institute (2025) — **Google Data Analytics Professional Certificate**, Coursera (2025) — **Computational Social Science Data Camp**, University of Pennsylvania (NSF, 2026)